Word Mastery

A Course in Phonics for the First Three Grades

BY

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HOUGHTON MIFFLIN COMPANY

The Riverside Press Cambridge

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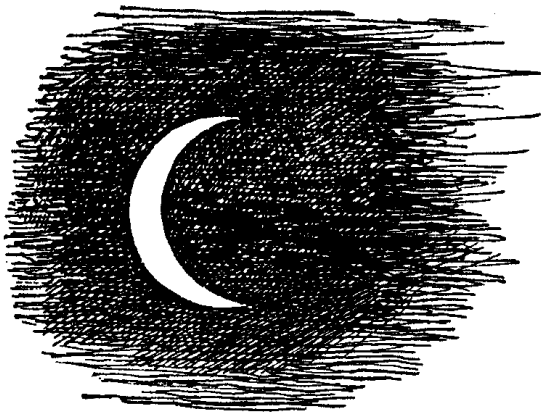
PREFACE

This little book is intended to be put into the hands of children at the beginning of their first year in school. It may be used in conjunction with any series of readers.

Teachers generally recognize the value of a good foundation in phonics as an important aid in learning to read. Unfortunately many teachers are not sufficiently familiar with the principles underlying phonic analysis and the building of words to feel sure that they can make their phonic drills as economical and as effective as they should be. Pupils, therefore, often fail to get sufficient phonic practice to become proficient in word recognition. Moreover, no matter how helpful the readers may be in suggestions as to teaching phonics, it devolves upon the teacher to prepare a great deal of phonic work. This requires much time and energy, as it must of necessity be presented to the pupils from the blackboard, or from large printed cards and charts. It has seemed to the author that it would be a great advantage to both teacher and pupil to have before the pupil in a book a carefully worked out and thoroughly tested series of exercises in phonics, which have been found to make pupils self-reliant in word mastery.

The author has evolved this system of teaching phonics in her own schoolroom, and has found that it ensures rapid progress in learning to read. It is presented to her fellow teachers with the hope that it may serve to lighten their burdens, and bring to them greater success in the fine art of teaching reading.

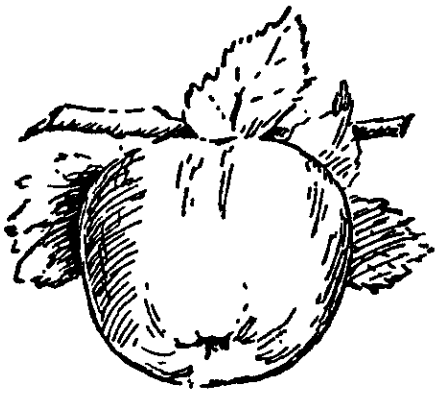
M m



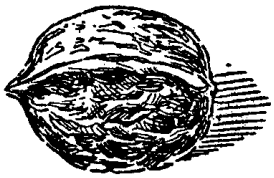
Do not undertake to teach these lessons until you have carefully studied the "Suggestions to Teachers," page 110.

M, n, r, f, s, l represent sounds that may be prolonged. This makes them the easiest of the consonant sounds to blend, and therefore to learn first. See directions on page 111 for teaching the sound of *m*.

A a



N n



man

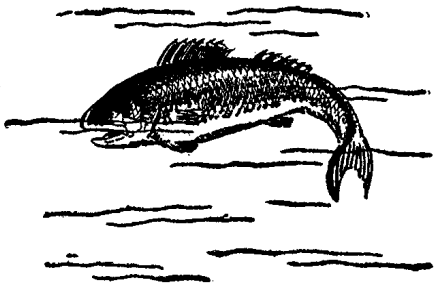
Pupils can now "build" the word *man:* they should first sound the word and then tell it. See page 111.

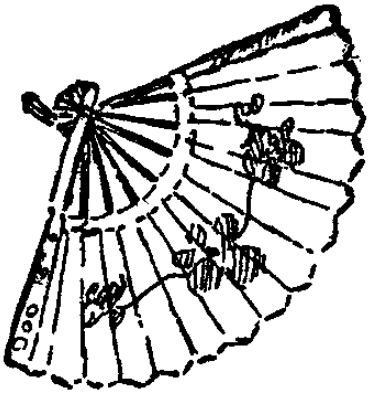
R r

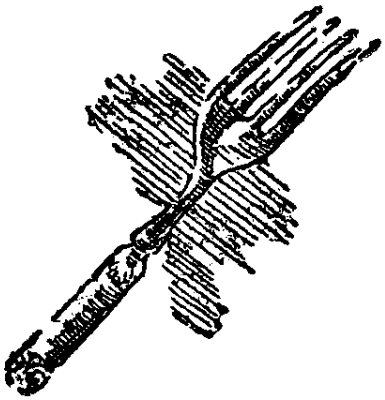
ran

Pupils should learn to tell the number of the page as they go over it. This will enable them to turn for review to any page required.

F f

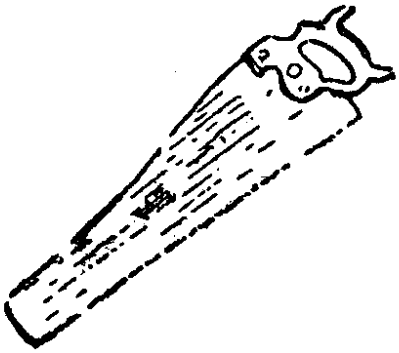


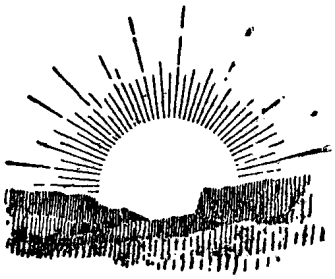




fan

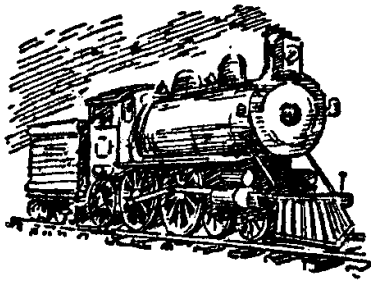
S s





Sam

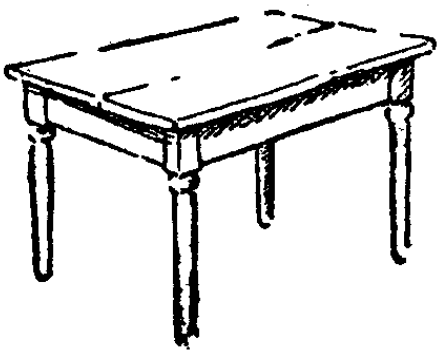
E e

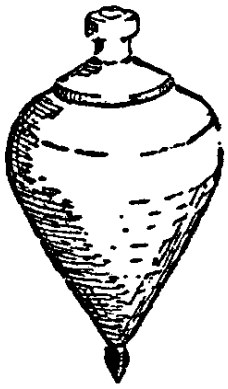


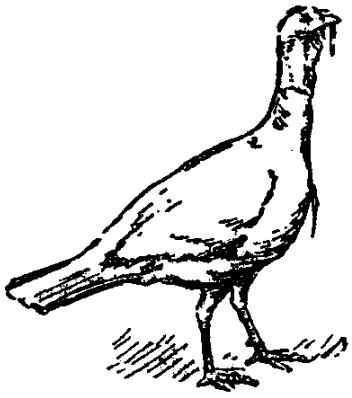
men	ran
man	man
fan	men
Sam	fan
ran	Sam

Take each step slowly at first. Lay the foundation well.

T t



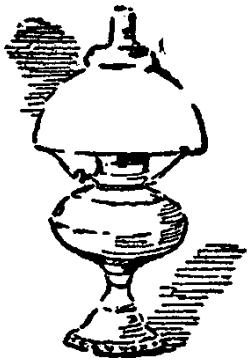




mat	set	ten
met	sat	tan
Nat	rat	
net	fat	

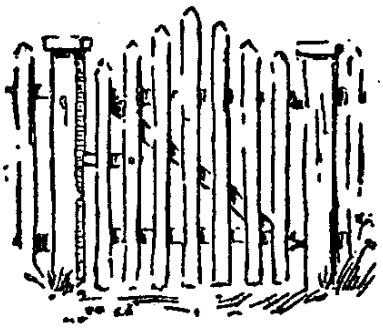
T, used first as a terminal, then as an initial sound.

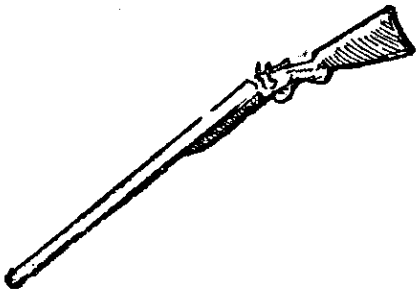
L l

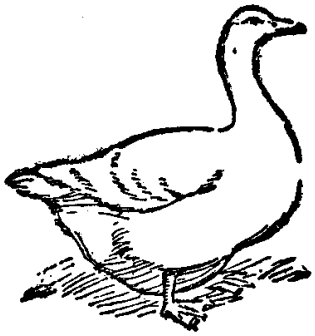


let

G g



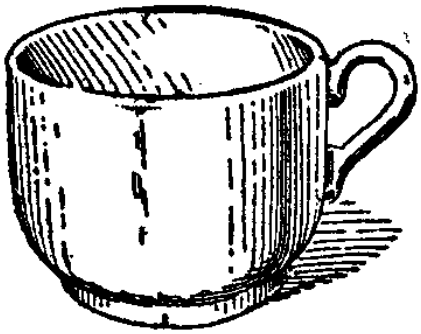


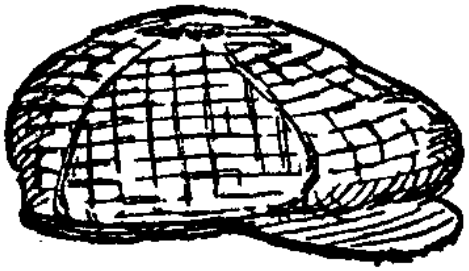


rag gas
tag get
sag gag

G, used first as a terminal, than as an initial sound.

C c

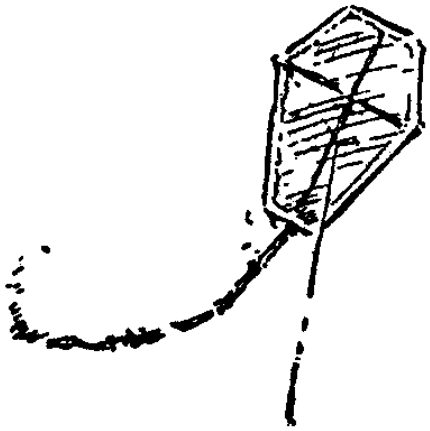


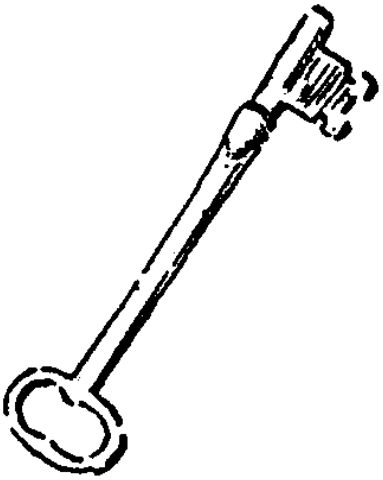


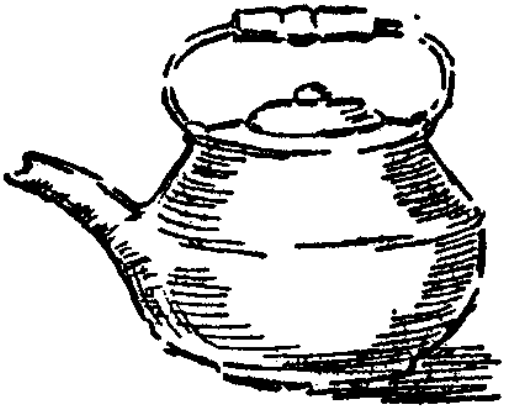
cat can

can cat

K k

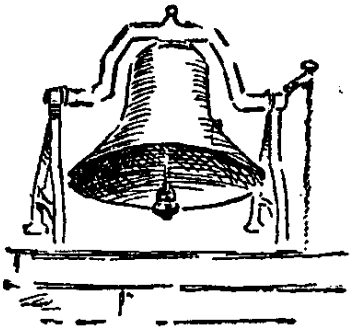


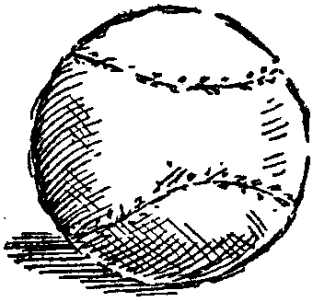




keg

B b





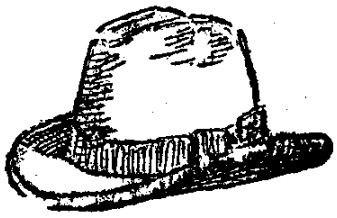
cab Ben bag
Tab bat beg

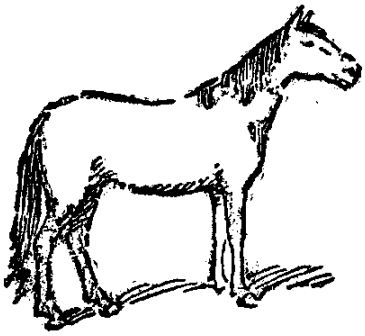
I i

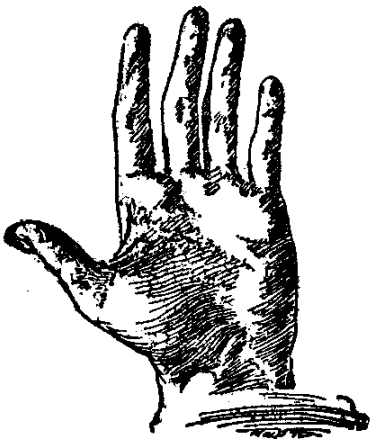
bit	tin	bib
bat	ten	big
sit	tan	beg
sat	fit	bag
set	fat	fin
fig	rib	rim

These pages require much patience and care.
Go slowly now, and speed will come later.

H h

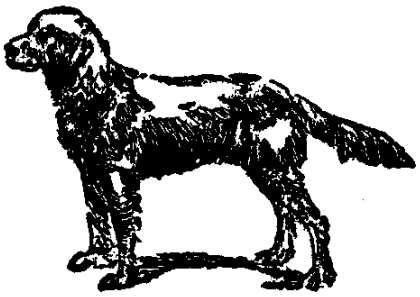


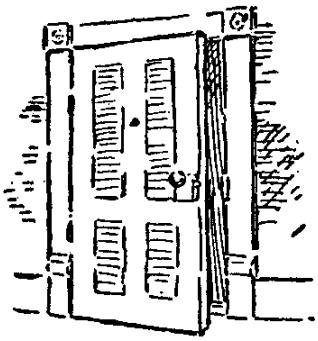




hat hem him
hit ham hen

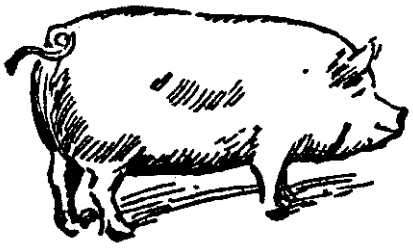
D d

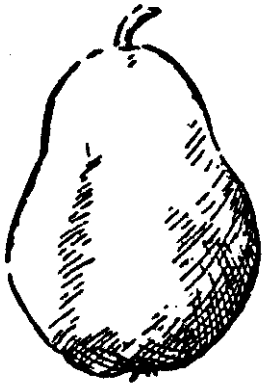


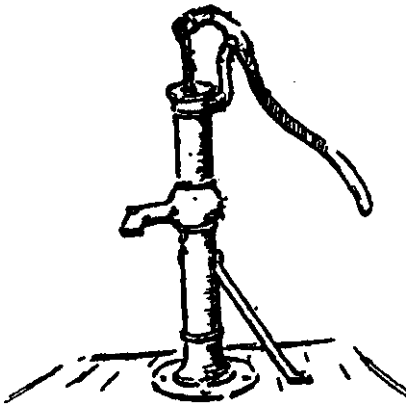


red	hid	sad
rid	had	did
lad	mad	den
led	mid	din
lid	bed	dig
fed	bad	dim

P p

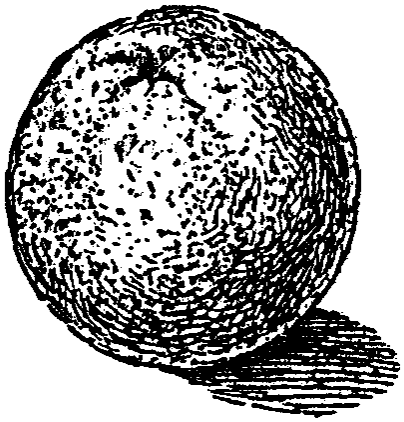






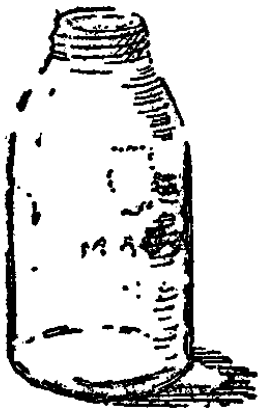
tap	map	pin
tip	lap	pen
rip	lip	pet
rap	cap	pat
sip	dip	pit
sap	hip	pig
nap	pan	peg

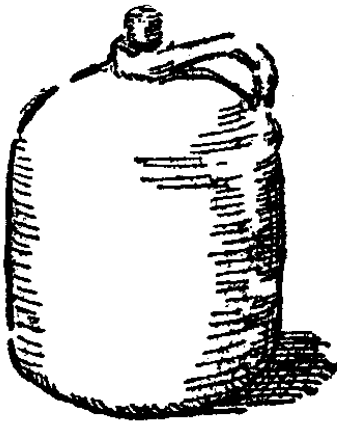
O o



log	rod	got
fog	rid	pot
fig	red	pat
cob	hop	pet
cab	hip	pit
rob	lap	hat
rib	lip	hit
nod	lop	hot
sod	top	let
pod	tap	lot
pad	tip	dot

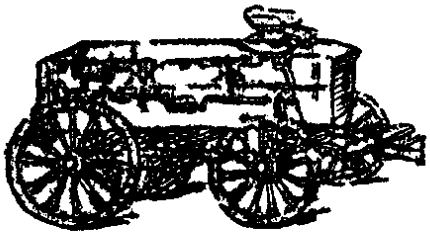
J j

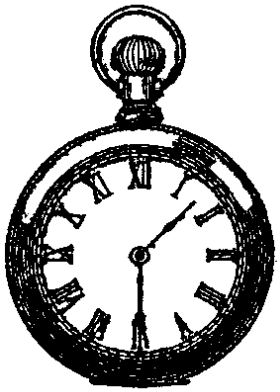




jam jet

W w



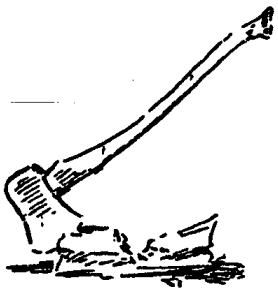


wag wit web
wig wet win

U u

gum	pug	run
hum	peg	bun
hem	pig	Ben
ham	tag	fun
him	tug	gun
bug	tub	sun
beg	hub	cut
bag	rub	hut
big	mud	hat
rag	bud	hot
rug	sup	hit
hug	cup	but
jug	pup	nut

Z z

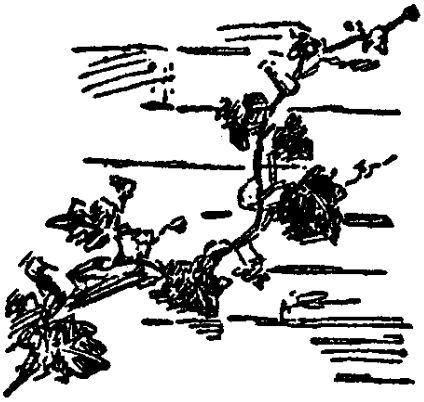
X  x

x = ks

ax box six

Q q

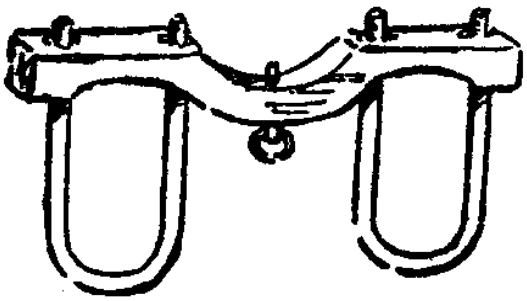
V v



vat van

van vat

Y y



yes yet

yet yes

a	e	i
at	n et	it
c at	p et	b it
b at	g et	h it
h at	l et	s it
s at	w et	w it
m at	s et	f it
p at	m et	p it
r at		

	h en	in
an	m en	p in
c an	p en	t in
f an	t en	s in
m an	B en	w in
p an	d en	f in
r an		

Be sure that pupils start each column with the short sound of the vowel.

Only one consonant preceding or following the vowel.

o	u	a
d ot	c ut	c ap
h ot	n ut	l ap
l ot	b ut	m ap
p ot	r ut	n ap
c ot	h ut	g ap
t ot		s ap
n ot	s un	t ap
g ot	g un	r ap
	f un	
h op	r un	b ad
m op	b un	h ad
p op		m ad
t op	up	s ad
l op	c up	p ad
s op	p up	l ad
	s up	

e	i	o
r ed	h id	p od
l ed	d id	r od
f ed	l id	n od
b ed	m id	s od
N ed	b id	
	k id	h og
h em	r id	l og
		f og
b eg	d ip	
l eg	h ip	c ob
k eg	l ip	r ob
p eg	r ip	m ob
	t ip	s ob
w eb	p ip	
	s ip	ox
R ex		b ox
v ex		f ox

	u		a		i
b	ud		am	h	im
m	ud	j	am	r	im
		h	am	d	im
g	um	S	am		
h	um			b	ig
		t	ag	d	ig
b	ug	b	ag	p	ig
r	ug	w	ag	f	ig
h	ug	r	ag	w	ig
m	ug	s	ag	j	ig
j	ug				
p	ug	c	ab	b	ib
t	ug	T	ab	r	ib
t	ub		ax	s	ix
r	ub	w	ax	f	ix
h	ub	t	ax	m	ix

an	c an	f an
at	c ap	f at
am	c ob	f ed
ax	c ot	f ig
	c ub	f in
b at	c up	f it
b ad	c ut	f og
b ag		f ox
b ed	d en	f un
b ig	d ip	
b it	d id	g as
b ox	d ig	g et
b ug	d im	g ot
	d ot	g um
c ab	d in	g un
c at	d ug	

This review is to strengthen the pupils' knowledge of consonant sounds.

h at
h ad
h am
h en
h id
h im
h ip
h it
h op
h og
h ot
h ug
h um
h ut

if
it
in

j am
j et
j ug

k eg

l ad
l ap
l et
l ed
l ip
l id
l og

m an
m ad
m ap
m at

m en
m et
m ix
m ud

n ap
n et
n ot
n od
n ut

on
ox

p an
p at
p eg
p en

p et
p ig
p in
p od
p op
p ug

r ag
r ed
r im
r ip
r ob
r ug
r un

s ad
s ag
s ap

s et
s in
s it
s ix
s ob
s od
s un

t ag
t an
t ap
t ax
t en
t in
t ip
t op
t ub
t ug

up
us

v an
v at
v ex

w ag
w ax
w eb
w et
w ig
w in

y es
y et

zig zag

can	let	tip
bit	pat	sad
ham	Tom	wax
let	beg	peg
Dan	rug	mix
lip	Nat	tub
rod	rap	box
beg	map	log
fed	bed	cab
sit	fig	hem
did	rob	red
tag	vex	big
lid	jug	keg
mat	rib	bat
Ben	top	ten
run	cup	led

General review without separating the phonograms.

The foundation is now laid. If the work has been well done success is assured.

Short – a e i o u
Long – a e i o u

at	c an	S am
ate	c ane	s ame
h at	p an	m ad
h ate	p ane	m ade
m at	m an	f ad
m ate	m ane	f ade
r at	c ap	h id
r ate	c ape	h ide
f at	t ap	d im
f ate	t ape	d ime

Teach the words *long* and *short* as whole or "sight" words. Practice sounding the vowels at the top of the page – both long and short

Final *e* is silent and usually makes the preceding vowel long.

f in	b it	l op
f ine	b ite	l ope
p in	r id	n ot
p ine	r ide	n ote
t in	r od	c ut
t ine	r ode	c ute
w in	r ob	us
w ine	r obe	use
d in	h op	t ub
d ine	h ope	t ube
r ip	m op	c ub
r ipe	m ope	c ube

a	l ame	i
w ade	t ame	s ide
s afe	J ane	w ide
b ake	l ane	t ide
r ake	b ase	l ife
c ake	c ase	w ife
l ake	v ase	m ile
w ake	K ate	p ile
m ake	d ate	t ile
t ake	g ate	f ile
g ale	l ate	l ime
p ale	c ave	t ime
s ale	g ave	m ine
t ale	p ave	l ine
c ame	s ave	v ine
g ame	w ave	n ine
n ame	g aze	w ipe

Long vowel sounds.

k ite
f ire
m ire
w ire
t ire
h ire
f ive
h ive
d ive
l ive

o

p oke
j oke
y oke
p ole
h ole
m ole

s ole
b one
c one
t one
l one
r ope
h ome
d ome
c ore
t ore
s ore
w ore
m ore
d ose

no
go
so

u

t une
J une
L uke
D uke
p ure
c ure
m ule
m ute

e

he
be
we
me

late	hive	home
mine	mane	cape
gave	rate	date
bite	tine	robe
pole	yoke	Duke
cane	pane	dive
wire	pile	fade
dime	more	gate
hope	ride	rode
pure	tire	vane
wore	pipe	hire
line	lake	ate
bone	pine	June
rake	ripe	cake
wove	tone	rope
time	life	vase

Review of long vowel sounds without separating the phonograms.

core	wake	hole
kite	Kate	tame
make	side	wine
same	lame	Luke
safe	note	tape
vine	Jane	wipe
sale	cure	bale
pale	wave	mule
vote	size	pave
sake	use	name
made	nine	bake
lone	mate	here
wade	cave	came
case	take	tune
dose	wide	fore
save	gaze	tide
fate	wife	cone
hide	lane	tone

c at	c ake	r akes
c ats	c akes	r ats
		m akes
c ap	g ate	w ipes
c aps	g ates	j okes
		b akes
s it	p ipe	t ips
s its	p ipes	d ates
		c ups
d ip	b ite	w akes
d ips	b ites	k ites
		w ets
t op	r ope	h opes
t ops	r opes	t aps
		f its
n ut	y oke	p ets
n uts	y okes	m aps

Showing the *s* form of words.

s = z	g ames	b ox es
as	t unes	s ix es
h as	r ose	h ose
is	r os es	w ise
h is	n ose	r ise
p ins	n os es	r is es
l ids	ax es	m ix es
r ugs	t ax es	f use

Ned’s cap	Ben’s cup
Kate’s rose	Sam’s bat
Tom’s cane	Ted’s dime
Jane’s cake	mule’s rope
Dan’s fox	cat’s bed
Dave’s home	hen’s leg
Nat’s box	man’s gun
Bob’s top	pig’s pen

S often has the sound of *z,* as in the first exercise. The second exercise shows the possessive form of words.

b ack	b ell	l ess
l ack	f ell	B ess
p ack	s ell	h iss
s ack	t ell	k iss
t ack	w ell	m iss
d eck	N ell	f uss
n eck	ill	m uss
p ick	b ill	
l ick	f ill	b uff
k ick	h ill	r uff
t ick	k ill	c uff
s ick	m ill	m uff
l ock	t ill	p uff
r ock	w ill	
b uck	d oll	f uzz
d uck	d ull	b uzz
l uck	h ull	

When two consonants having the same sound come together, only one is sounded.

an d	h int	d ust
h and	l int	m ust
l and	m int	r ust
s and	t int	j ust
b and	h unt	
en d		c amp
b end	b est	d amp
m end	n est	l amp
s end	t est	l imp
w ind	w est	r omp
p ond	r est	b ump
	v est	d ump
b ent	l ist	j ump
r ent	f ist	l ump
s ent	m ist	p ump
t ent		
w ent		s elf

Two different consonants following the vowel.

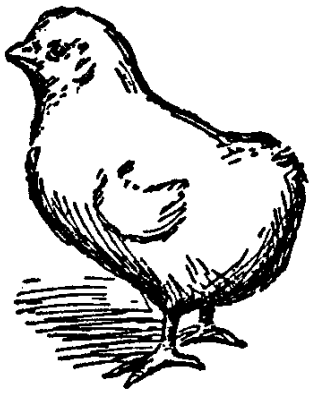
b elt	g ift	elk
f elt	l ift	m ilk
m elt	r ift	s ilk
w ilt	s ift	b ulk
h elp	k ept	n ext
y elp	w ept	t ext

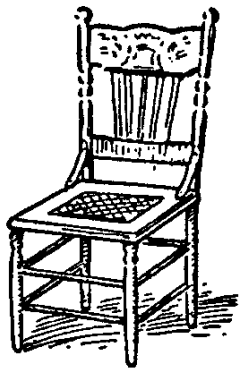
---

left	send	hand
huff	tilt	sift
hemp	hint	lend
went	west	hiss
less	romp	held
Jack	Bess	add
Jill	wick	Bell
next	pump	dent
mock	Dick	Bill

The second exercise is a review.

ch





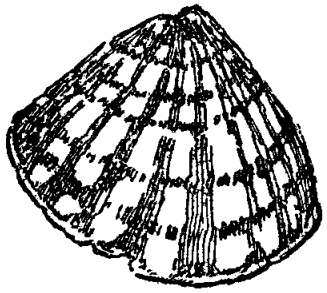
ch ime
ch ick
ch oke

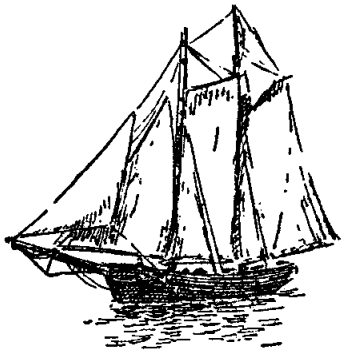
ch in
ch ap
ch ase
ch eck
ch ill
ch afe
ch ip
ch at
ch op
ch ose
s uch
m uch
r ich
b en ch
l un ch
b un ch
p un ch

p atch
l atch
c atch
h atch
m atch
itch
w itch
p itch
h itch
d itch
n otch
b otch
D utch

New sound – ch
***T* is silent before *ch*.**

sh





sh ade
sh ake
sh all

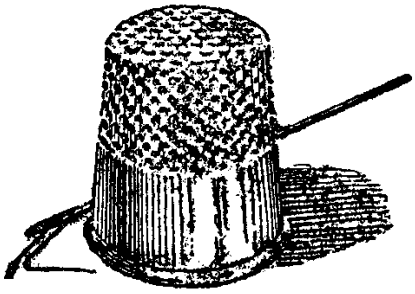
sh ame
sh ape
sh ed
sh ell
sh elf
sh ine
sh ip
sh ock
sh od
sh one
sh ot
sh ore
sh op
sh un
sh ut
sh ave

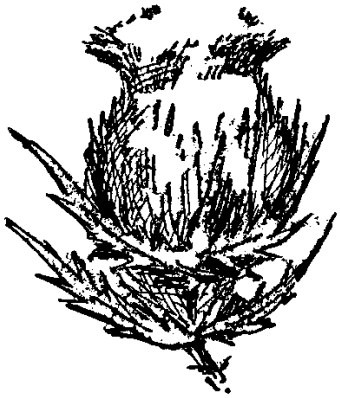
ash
c ash
d ash
l ash
m ash
s ash
d ish
w ish
f ish
h ush
r ush

sh r ub
shr ill
shr imp
shr ed
shr ug

New sound – *sh*

th





w idth
t enth

thr ill
thr ob
thr ive
thr one
thr ash
thr ush
thr ust
thr ift

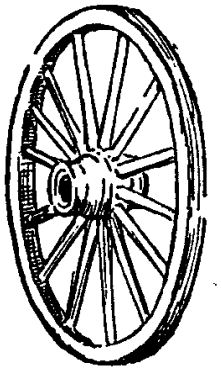
th e
th at
th en
th is
th ese
th ose
th em
th us
th ine
th an

th in
th ick
th ump

w ith
b athe

On this page are two new sounds – the voiced and the voiceless sound of *th*. It is often necessary for a pupil to sound the word both ways in order to discover the correct pronunciation.

wh



wh ip
wh ale
wh en
wh et
wh ich
wh ine
wh iff

wh ile
wh ack
wh ite
wh im
wh iz

---

shake	chill	shuck
thatch	mush	chop
chores	whine	then
which	with	chest
shift	shade	thrush
this	these	shrill

First exercise shows a new sound – *wh*.
Second exercise is a review of *ch, sh, th,* and *wh*.

bl	pl	cr	gr	sm
cl	sp	sc	pr	sn
fl	sl	dr	tr	sw
gl	br	fr	st	tw

---

bl ack	cl ick	fl ag
bl ade	cl ock	fl ake
bl ame	cl uck	fl ame
bl aze	cl am	fl at
bl ed	cl ap	fl ax
bl ess	cl ip	fl esh
bl ock	cl od	fl it
b lot	cl ose	fl ock
bl uff	cl ub	fl op
bl unt	cl utch	fl ash
bl ush	cl ove	fl ume

Consonant combinations. Pupils should practice blending the two consonants so closely that they form but one sound.

gl ad
gl ade
gl aze
gl ass
gl ide
gl obe

pl an
pl ant
pl ate
pl ot
pl um
pl ume
pl ush

s pl ash
spl it
spl int

sp ade
sp an
sp eck
sp ell
sp end
sp ill
sp in
sp ine
sp oke
sp ot
sp un
sp ike
sp ire
sp ite
w isp
l isp

sl ack
sl ab
sl ash
sl am
sl at
sl ate
sl ave
sl ed
sl ip
sl id
sl it
sl im
sl ime
sl ide
sl ope
sl ush
sl ug

br an
br ag
br ake
br ave
br ick
br ide
br im
br oke
br ush
br ine

cr ab
cr ack
cr ate
cr ane
cr op
cr amp
cr isp

cr imp
cr ept
cr ib
cr ush
cr ock
cr ust

s cr ap
scr ape
scr atch
scr ub

sc amp
sc at
sc ale
sc ant
sc ore

sc um
Sc otch
sk ate
sk etch
sk iff
sk ill
sk ull
sk ip
sk im
sk in

r isk
br isk
h usk
d usk
m usk
t usk

dr ag
dr ess
dr ift
dr ill
dr ive
dr op
dr ove
dr ug
dr um
dr ip
dr ape
dr one

fr ame
fr et
fr esh
Fr ench
fr ill

fr og
fr ock
fr om
fr isk
fr oze

gr ade
gr and
gr aze
gr ate
gr ave
gr ape
gr ip
gr it
gr ill
gr in
gr ove
gr unt

pr ess
pr ide
pr ize
pr op
pr ose
pr int

s pr ig
spr ite

tr ack
tr act
tr amp
tr ash
tr ap
tr ade
tr ick
tr ill

tr im
tr ip
tr od
tr ot
tr uck

s tr ip
str ipe
str etch
str ive
str ict
str ide
str ike
str ap
str oke

st ab
st ack
st ake
st ale
st amp
st omp
st ump
st and
st ep
st ate
st em
st ick
st iff
st ill
st ilt
st itch
st ole
st ove

st one
st op
st ub
st uck
st uff
st ore
h aste
p aste
w aste
t aste
b aste
cr est
ch est
l est
bl est
cr ust
tr ust

sm ell	sw am	**qu**
sm elt	sw ell	qu ack
sm ash	sw ept	qu ill
sm ile	sw im	qu ilt
sm ith	sw um	qu it
sm oke	sw ine	qu ite
sm ack	sw itch	qu iz
	sw ore	qu ick
sn ake	sw ift	
sn ap		s qu int
sn atch	tw ig	
sn iff	tw ill	
sn uff	tw ine	
sn ipe	tw ist	
sn ore	tw it	
sn ug	tw itch	
sn ag	tw ins	

New combination – *qu*

blend	crust	clamp
stripe	trade	sprig
broke	frame	scrape
fleck	twist	risk
slide	spend	flap
stitch	grim	snatch
drape	quench	scamp
smile	fluff	splash
print	skate	swift

---

d og	cr oss	l ost
off	gl oss	fr ost
l oss	l oft	m oth
t oss	s oft	fr oth
m oss	c ost	cl oth

First exercise is a review.

The vowel sound in the lower list of words differs slightly from the short sound of *o*. Webster's New International Dictionary gives it a mark indicating a medial sound between that of *o* in *orb* and the *o* of *odd*. Special care should be taken to give pupils the correct pronunciation of these words.

y es	pup py	**y=long i**
y et	car ry	by
y ell	emp ty	my
y elp	dust y	cr y
Y ale	twen ty	dr y
y oke	fif ty	fl y
	six ty	fr y
y=short i	nine ty	pr y
cand y	cop y	sl y
cher ry	fluff y	sp y
mer ry	fun ny	th y
wind y	jol ly	tr y
kit ty	fog gy	wh y
pen ny	Bet ty	r ye
chill y	Hen ry	sh y
sor ry	Bun ny	sk y
sun ny	Pol ly	st yle

Three sounds of *y*.

ai, ay = long a	sail	pain
	snail	lain
ai d	pail	plain
l aid	tail	slain
m aid	trail	chain
	aim	stain
paid	claim	faint
braid	gain	paint
ail	rain	quaint
fail	drain	raise
bail	brain	praise
rail	grain	waist
hail	train	bait
jail	strain	gait
mail	sprain	wait
nail	main	strait

When two vowels come together, the first is usually long and the second silent.

b ay	ea, ee = long e	speak
d ay		weak
r ay	s ea	streak
t ray	t ea	sneak
g ay	fl ea	squeak
	ea ch	heal
gray	b each	meal
hay		seal
lay	peach	squeal
clay	reach	steal
may	teach	beam
pay	bead	seam
play	lead	team
say	read	steam
stay	leaf	stream
stray	leak	dream
way	beak	bean
pray	peak	lean

mean	please	see
clean	east	fee
heap	beast	bee
leap	feast	flee
cheap	yeast	free
reap	eat	glee
ear	beat	three
fear	heat	tree
hear	meat	beech
near	neat	leech
tear	seat	speech
dear	cheat	screech
year	treat	deed
clear	wheat	feed
shear	eaves	need
ease	leave	seed
easy	heave	weed
tease	weave	bleed

reed
greed
beef
reef
seek
week
cheek
creek
meek
eel
feel
heel
keel
peel
reel
steel
seem
seen

screen
keen
queen
green
sheen
deep
keep
sheep
steep
sweep
creep
sleep
peep
deer
cheer
queer
beet
feet

meet
sheet
sweet
street
fleet
greet
breeze
freeze
sneeze
squeeze

ie – long i

d ie
l ie

fie
pie
tie

oa } **=long o**	groan	coast
oe	loan	boast
l oad	moan	
r oad	soap	t oe
t oad	oat	w oe
l oaf	coat	
c oach	float	hoe
	goat	foe
poach	boat	
roach	throat	**ue = long u**
oak	oar	s ue
cloak	soar	c ue
croak	roar	
soak	board	hue
coal	coarse	due
goal	hoarse	
foam	roast	
roam	toast	

long i

m ild

wild
child
bind
blind
find
hind
kind
mind
wind
grind

igh – long i

s igh
s igh t

fight
might
high
light
night
right
tight
bright
flight

long o

old
t old

cold
gold
hold

mold
sold
scold
roll
toll
stroll
post
most
colt
jolt
bolt
pork
torn
worn
porch
forth
both

***I* is long when followed by *ld, nd*, or *gh*.**
***O* is long when followed by *ld, st,* or *lt*.**

ow

ow l
h owl

fowl
scowl
growl
bow
brow
cow
how
now
plow

mow
down
town
gown
clown
frown
crown
brown
drown
crowd
drowsy

ou = ow

couch

crouch
pouch
slouch

loud
cloud
proud
bound
found
mound
pound
round
ground
sound
wound
count
mount
our
sour
scour
flour
house

mouse
grouse
blouse
out
pout
spout
sprout
stout
trout
shout
mouth
south

ow
ou
= long o

owe
bow
low

blow
flow
row
grow
glow
crow
mow
show
snow
throw
stow
bowl
own
mown
sown
blown
grown
flown

thrown
growth
yellow
window
elbow
hollow
mellow
widow
shadow
four
pour
court
course
soul

ing ings

k ing	matting	singing
k ings	running	bringing
r ing	boxing	fretting
r ings	rubbing	trying
s ing	mixing	braiding
s ings	packing	playing
	filling	reading
string	puffing	meeting
sling	buzzing	loaning
wing	bending	lighting
wings	hunting	folding
swing	resting	rolling
spring	jumping	plowing
springs	helping	counting
bring	adding	flowing
cling	wishing	pouring
thing	spending	minding
things	throwing	steering

er ers

h er	rubber	crackers
were	deeper	brighter
j erk	temper	Easter
n erve	pitcher	miller
	hammer	grinder
perch	timber	counter
fern	roller	sleeper
verse	rollers	teacher
ever	thunder	owner
stern	older	owners
term	colder	sifter
sister	dinner	browner
sisters	rocker	gayer
flower	painter	bitter
flowers	painters	upper
winter	wilder	tender
winters	summer	singer
better	cracker	servant

skipper	lye	sketch
creek	please	snow
grain	leaf	grape
might	swell	roller
mint	perch	slush
soak	bill	night
mine	sling	totter
cream	beet	failing
roaring	foggy	gray
chase	graze	prize
owe	ore	woe
fright	power	laid
bunch	howl	saying
snail	told	rose
spring	fear	board
flyer	meaning	rain
speak	ground	waste
strike	lost	thrown

General review.

flesh	blade	Jack’s
bone	socks	leader
shift	drugs	snake
supper	mopping	froth
trust	stretch	post
sorrow	sand	whiz
perch	peach	cores
off	patter	thrush
four	glad	stand
suppose	clinch	plump
clings	bench	twine
greedy	weaker	blister
cloth	offer	June
follow	scolding	shelf
jail	west	wetter
spins	flock	sweep
coal	shaggy	pills
smear	house	wades
rise	still	throat

slope	smile	twelfth
feeds	toss	dray
stake	study	oaks
cheese	splash	frills
tinner	street	coats
times	shadow	cherry
swept	snatch	saves
cheek	trout	frosty
trench	crust	feelers
ever	vote	lamp
fish	stitch	preach
shells	kind	sleeve
bluff	twig	toast
sniffs	clerk	May’s
tried	sweets	crown
teeth	pepper	style
wing	brain	teams
hack	close	pillow
cost	mouse	breeze

ang ong ung eng

bang	song	sung
hang	songs	stung
hanger	gong	swung
rang	pong	slung
gang	strong	sprung
gangway	tongs	strung
clang	hung	length
sprang	rung	strength

---

n = ng	thanking	think
bank	drank	blink
blank	sank	sunk
clank	tank	chunk
plank	ink	trunk
rank	link	trunks
rank	link	trunks
crank	mink	stronger
Frank	pink	hunger
Frank's	sink	hungry
thank	drink	angry

making	raising	trading
grading	spading	striking
skating	sloping	stroking
waving	closing	framing
hiding	blazing	blaming
riding	taking	flaming
smiling	mining	scraping
chiming	storing	whining
shining	lining	bathing
stoning	breezing	thriving
driving	squeezing	shaving
smoking	pleasing	choking
hoping	leaving	chasing
curing	weaving	taming
wading	praising	siding
piling	wasting	filing
raking	toasting	snoring
draping	pasting	hiring

Final *e* dropped when *ing* is added.

kn = n

knob
knot
knee
kneel
knit
knits
knife
know
knows
known
knight
knead
kneads
kneading
knack
knock
knocks
knocking

wr = r

wrap
wraps
wren
wrench
wrenches
wring
wringer
wringing
wrist
wrists
wrong
write
writes
writing
wrote
wreath
wreck
wrecks

mb = m

lamb
lambkins
limb
comb
climb
dumb
crumb
numb
plumbing
thumb

gn = n

gnat
gnats
gnash
gnashes
sign
signboard

gu = g	league	buys
guess	leagues	buyer
guesses		buying
Guy	**bu = b**	
guide	build	**bt = t**
guides	builds	doubt
guiding	builder	doubts
plague	buy	debts

---

wrist	wrench	doubt
comb	gnat	guest
guess	writes	wrong
build	know	knock
debts	guide	gnash
buy	kneel	dumb
wreath	limb	knot

The second exercise is a review.

matting	pinning	holly
mating	pining	holy
lopping	dinner	latter
loping	diner	later
filling	mopping	hopping
filing	moping	hoping
slopping	shamming	batting
sloping	shaming	bating

---

happy	planning	blotter
ladder	supper	cracker
bonnet	yellow	rabbit
motto	begging	carry
summer	shabby	hammer

A vowel is short when there are two consonants having the same sound between it and the next vowel.

napkin	velvet	public
silver	lifting	mending
pilgrim	pumpkin	pitcher
candy	sister	dentist
dustpan	renting	picnic
number	trumpet	melting
window	slender	empty
camping	crusty	thunder

---

story	smiling	zero
closing	pupil	cozy
baker	pony	hero
duty	sober	tiger
navy	tulip	tiny
solo	lady	gravy
fever	clover	paper
music	shady	hazy

A vowel is short when there are two or more different consonants between it and the next vowel, and long when there is but one consonant between it and the next vowel.

There are frequent exceptions to this rule, yet it is helpful.

ai = short i
captain
fountain
mountain

ea = long a
break
breaks
breaker
breakers
breaking
daybreak
great
greater
steak
beefsteak

ea = short e
head
dead
read
ready
dread
dreads
lead
bread
spread
thread
deaf
breast
health
healthy
wealth
wealthy
meant
feather
leather
weather
heavy
sweat
breath
meadow

ie = long e
chief
thief
thieves
brief
field
priest
tier
wield
yield
shield
grief
grieve
grieves

ed	crowded	waded
petted	sifted	seated
landed	folded	pouted
faded	clouded	roasted
tested	boasted	handed
needed	tended	doubted
twisted	rented	coasted
wicked	jolted	mended
tinted	graded	weeded

---

ed = d	peeled	soured
sailed	frowned	buttered
played	foamed	roared
keeled	crowed	wheeled
mired	breathed	scattered
plowed	pinned	shivered
aimed	prayed	cleaned
loaned	climbed	snowed
growled	sealed	canned

ed = t	wrecked	kissed
reached	liked	guessed
puffed	wrapped	dropped
baked	stamped	coaxed
clapped	leaped	checked
ticked	dressed	shipped
brushed	knocked	scraped
patched	wrenched	dashed
choked	packed	milked

---

mounted	skated	sighed
battered	grunted	painted
rusted	wretched	lacked
cried	begged	mailed
floated	ailed	kicked
pained	mixed	rained
strayed	tacked	heaped
cracked	missed	lighted

The second exercise is a review of the phonograms. The words are new.

ie, ey = short y	kitties	sixties
	daisies	carries
Annie	stories	berries
Jimmie	candies	copies
Bessie	ponies	pansies
Hattie	ladies	bunnies
Jessie	pennies	donkey
Lizzie	empties	chimney
Nellie	fifties	alley
Willie	puppies	valley

---

ei, eigh, ey = long a	reign	weight
	eight	sleigh
	eighteen	neigh
skein	eighty	freight
reins	eighty-five	they
reindeer	eighty-six	greyhound
veil	eighty-eight	whey
vein	weigh	prey

boot

oo
o
u
ou
ui
ew

like long oo in boot

too	gloom	loose
hoof	gloomy	broom
roof	soon	root
proof	moon	hoot
cool	noon	shoot
pool	spoon	boost
tool	teaspoon	choose
stool	loop	coo
spool	looped	coop
food	droop	scoop
room	stoop	scooped
boom	hoop	groove
bloom	goose	poor

smooth
smoothed
soothe
troop
tooth
do
to
move
prove
proves
shoe
shoemaker
tomb
blue
glue
true
rude
ruby
rubies

rule
prune
Ruth
truth
Gertrude
soup
croup
group
grouped
fruit
bruise
bruised
cruise
drew
grew
crew
screw
strew
threw

chew
flew

wh = h

whoop
who
whom
whose

ew = long u

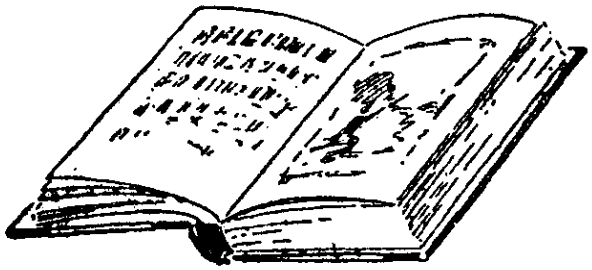
mew
new
dew
stew
few

oo = long o

door
floor

When *u* is preceded by r, it has the sound of long *oo*.

book



oo
o
oul
u

like short oo in book

good	took	put
good-bye	undertook	putting
hood	look	puss
childhood	looked	push
stood	brook	bush
understood	brooks	bushes
wood	crook	cuckoo
woods	crooked	butcher
woodpile	foot	pudding
woodshed	wool	puddings
cook	wolf	pull
cooking	wolves	pulling
hook	could	pulled
fishhook	would	pulpit
shook	should	full

ful	truthful	playful
cheerful	painful	plentiful
thankful	fretful	healthful
dreadful	frightful	restful
powerful	fearful	useful
tearful	bashful	hopeful
spiteful	hateful	shameful
helpful	grateful	doubtful

---

oi } like **oy** in **boy**
oy

	coin	toy
	join	Roy
oil	joint	joy
toil	point	enjoy
soil	moist	joyful
boil	noise	oyster
spoil	noisy	boyhood

apple	handle	battle
cattle	eagle	buckle
saddle	tremble	paddle
tumble	bundle	twinkle
candle	brittle	pebble
thimble	middle	rumble
steeple	people	settle
cuddle	table	crumble
puddle	ruffle	shingle
tingle	crackle	
pickle	stumble	**tle = l**
tangle	wrinkle	thistle
kettle	single	wrestle
maple	dimple	whistle
bottle	bugle	bristle
beetle	needle	nestle
cradle	stable	rustle
wiggle	riddle	trestle

***T* is silent in *tle* after s.**

$$c = s \text{ before } \begin{cases} e \\ i \\ y \end{cases}$$

ice	fence	choice
rice	quince	grocery
mice	since	ceil
nice	Prince	pencil
slice	Alice	city
price	ounce	cider
twice	bounce	cinders
face	flounce	icicle
lace	cell	juice
place	center	juicy
space	cease	spice
race	piece	spicy
trace	niece	cyclone
brace	fierce	bicycle
Grace	voice	Lucy

***C* before *e, i,* or *y* has the sound of *s*.**

g = j before { e, i, y }

		dg = j
		badge
		Madge
gem	fringe	edge
age	plunge	ledge
gage	Roger	hedge
sage	gentle	wedge
rage	huge	sledge
stage	college	pledge
cage	gill	dredge
page	engine	ridge
range	ginger	bridge
change	gingerbread	dodge
strange	magic	lodge
stranger	Gyp	budge
danger	Egypt	nudge
manger	gypsy	judge
hinge	dingy	

***G* before *e, i,* or *y* usually has the sound of *j*.**

ly	slyly	gently
safely	nicely	kindly
gaily	softly	lately
fully	likely	truly
sadly	daily	bravely
gladly	badly	neatly
lightly	freely	nearly
slowly	swiftly	wholly
poorly	quickly	closely
loudly	lonely	ugly
kingly	mostly	boldly

---

less	tasteless	shameless
blameless	tireless	priceless
aimless	lifeless	endless
wireless	painless	senseless
useless	hopeless	thankless
homeless	boundless	restless
fearless	matchless	speechless

ness	stillness	soreness
sweetness	lameness	sadness
meanness	thickness	sickness
kindness	weakness	goodness
illness	loneliness	happiness

---

est	lamest	reddest
coldest	dampest	softest
nicest	sorest	crossest
loudest	stiffest	gladdest
lightest	wisest	grandest
slowest	latest	biggest
kindest	finest	nearest
tamest	lowest	blackest
safest	oldest	newest
tightest	widest	stillest
ripest	dearest	thickest
wildest	brightest	freshest
sweetest	roundest	happiest

ar
ear
ir
or
ur
= er

	search	thirty
	earth	circle
	heard	thirsty
	pearl	word
	bird	work
	chirp	world
lantern	girl	worm
desert	first	worse
finger	skirt	worst
rooster	birthday	worth
every	shirt	stubborn
flutter	stir	flavor
spider	dirt	tailor
beggar	fir	sailor
cedar	firm	doctor
dollar	squirm	neighbor
backward	third	bur
earn	whirl	fur
learn	squirrel	blur

sturdy	nurse	burst
urge	churn	purple
curl	burn	church
curly	turn	turtle
hurl	hurt	further
purse	curve	nursery

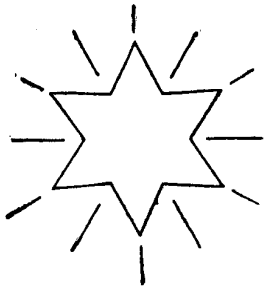
---

ish	foolish	stylish
dish	finish	Irish
wish	polish	Spanish
fish	selfish	British
rubbish	punish	furnish

---

butterfly	sunbeams	himself
grapevine	sunset	firefly
raindrops	sunrise	fireside
rainbow	cobweb	midnight
dewdrops	forget	windmill
sunshine	blackboard	daylight

This exercise is a review of phonograms, with new words.



a
au } like **a** in **star**

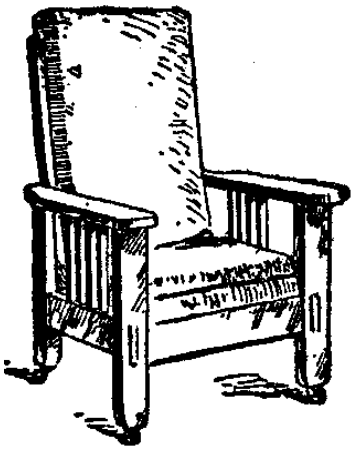
	starlight	lark
	starch	arm
bar	starve	farm
marble	hard	harm
march	yard	harmless
arch	bark	charm
car	dark	barn
card	darkness	darn
scar	mark	yarn
far	park	art
jar	parlor	artist
tar	spark	tart
star	sparkle	cart

When *a* and *r* come together, if *a* does not follow a vowel, their sound is usually the name of the letter *r*.
(The exceptions are in such words as *war*. page 94.)

dart	grandpa	**lf = f**
part	grandma	calf
party	father	calves
chart	grandfather	half
start	aunt	halves
startle	jaunt	
large	launch	**lm = m**
charge	craunch	calm
sharp	laundry	calmly
harvest		palm

---

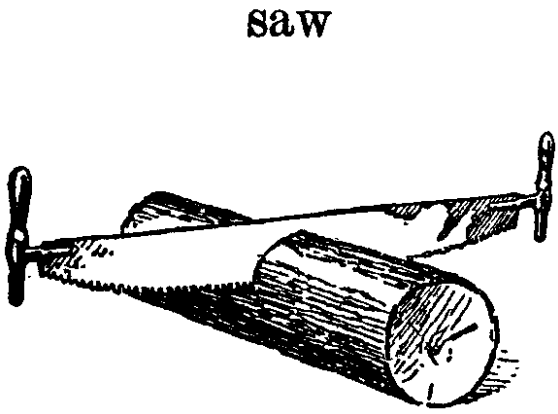
chair



ar
air
ear } like **air** in **chair**
eir
ere

care	carefully	carelessly

careful
careless
carelessness
careworn
flare
staircase
dare
snare
stairway
daring
stare
bear
fare
share
grizzly bear
farewell
shared
polar bear
bare
scare
pear
barefoot
scarecrow
tear
threadbare
scarce
tearing
hare
scarcely
wear
spare
air
wears
square
airy
their
squarely
fair
theirs
rare
fairy
ere
rarely
fairest
there
rarest
hair
therefore
ware
hairbrush
where
hardware
pair
wherever
glare
armchair
nowhere
glaring
stair
elsewhere



a
aw
au
augh
o
ough

like **aw** in **saw**

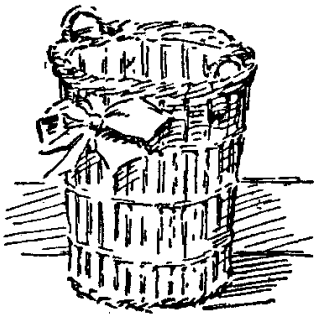
all	**lk = k**	wharf
almost	walk	quart
ball	sidewalk	quarter
baseball	talk	wigwam
call	chalk	water
fall	stalk	want
hall		jaw
tall	war	gnaw
wall	warble	law
walnut	warm	claw
stall	warn	paw
small	warning	hawk
salt	swarm	draw

straw	caught	corner
strawberry	taught	scorn
thaw	daughter	horn
awl	or	thorn
scrawl	order	north
squaw	border	touch
awning	for	scorch
shawl	nor	sort
dawn	cord	short
lawn	cork	morn
yawn	horse	morning
fault	form	orchard
saucer	storm	ought
cause	stormy	bought
gauze	fork	brought
pause	stork	fought
haul	New York	sought
author	born	thought
Paul	corn	nought

ough = long o	although	doughnut
though	dough	borough

---

basket



a as in **basket**

	after	master
	afterwards	past
	rafter	path
ant	ask	bath
grant	task	branch
slant	mask	brass
chance	clasp	class
dance	gasp	glass
glance	cast	grass
France	fast	mass
raft	last	pass
draft	blast	chaff
craft	mast	giraffe

a = short o

was	watchful	waffle
swan	what	waffles
wand	wash	wallow
wander	washing	swallow
wandered	washboard	swallows
wandering	washtub	swamp
wasp	whitewash	swamps
wasps	squash	swampy
watch	wad	quality
watchman	wads	quantity

---

o, ou, oo = short u

son	won	wonderfully
grandson	wonder	none
ton	wonderful	done

some
somebody
somebody's
somehow
something
sometime
sometimes
somewhat
somewhere
come
coming
love
lovely
loveliest
above
shove
dove
gloves
sponge
sponges
tongue
tongues
front
month
nothing
cover
covered
color
colors
colored
comfort
other
others
another
mother
mother's
grandmother
brother
smother
smothered
oven
govern
dozen
London
young
younger
wondrous
serious
touched
trouble
southern
double
country
countries
couple
flood
blood

half-long a	damage	savage
furnace	bandage	Sunday
necklace	cottage	Friday
surface	voyage	Thursday
package	courage	Tuesday

---

half-long e	beyond	relief
became	deceive	recess
before	decide	receive
begin	delay	recite
began	delight	rejoice
begun	deliver	reply
behind	declare	recover
belong	depend	pretend
behave	desire	preserve
below	despair	prefer
between	select	erase
besides	secure	cement

Unaccented vowels. To discover the words, pupils should sound these vowels long. Familiarity with the spoken word will enable them to make these vowels more or less obscure.

half-long o	protect	factory
oblige	provide	memory
obey	propel	daffodil
disobey	profess	evaporate
polite	produce	tobacco
provoke	ivory	November

---

half-long u	capture	gesture
unite	lecture	venture
united	furniture	pasture
future	moisture	century
picture	mixture	failure

---

obscure a	amid	around
ago	alone	away
awoke	asleep	astray
adrift	alike	about
afloat	afraid	aloud

Second exercise – **When *t* precedes half-long *u*, together these letters form a more or less clear *ch* sound.**

Third exercise – To discover the words, pupils should sound these and the following obscure vowels like short *u*.

arise	India	Cinderella
along	China	umbrella
soda	collar	salad
sofa	lizard	spectacles
Clara	manager	climate

---

obscure a	instant	disappoint
real	servant	appear
medal	giant	disappear
loyal	currant	balloon
royal	vacant	account
final	lilac	errand
crystal	arrange	balance
several	Scotland	arrest
hospital	Holland	madam
emerald	fisherman	allow
distant	German	breakfast

The sound of *a* in the lower exercise differs slightly in pronunciation from its sound in the preceding exercise, hence these two sounds are offered in separate groups.

obscure e	flannel	present
jewel	vessel	agent
cruel	gravel	silent
camel	level	absent
angel	travel	mitten
barrel	satchel	passenger
towel	bushel	hello
chisel	moment	children

---

obscure o	consent	cannon
commence	connect	seldom
complete	content	blossom
complaint	contain	bottom
welcome	console	parrot
tiresome	lion	pilot
handsome	melon	gallop
confess	lemon	occur
concern	lemonade	offend
conclude	ribbon	conductor
control	wagon	hammock

obscure u	subtract	sirup
suppose	circus	stirrup
suggest	Saturday	
succeed	album	

---

en, in, on = n	kitten	**ten = n**
	sweeten	glisten
	maiden	often
	sudden	soften
golden	basin	listen
open	raisin	hasten
chosen	button	
broken	cotton	**el = l**
frozen	season	ravel
seven	reason	mantel
given	lesson	tassel
stolen	poison	shrivel
widen	prison	

In the second exercise there are elided vowels. They may be presented to the pupils as silent.

dismiss
disgust
dislike
dispute
display
distress
divide
direct
impure
inclose
include
include
increase
indeed
injure
injury
inside
inquire
incline
intend

invent
invite
interrupt
engage
enemy
entire
entirely
enter
unload
unlike
unwise
unwise
uneasy
untwist
unjust
untie
unknown
until
uproar
upset

excite
excel
exercise
except
excuse
explode
explain
extreme
express
expect
except
exchange

ex – egz

exact
exactly
examine
example
exist
exert

potato	habit	because
pocket	robin	carpet
palace	bridle	sharpen
shoulder	kitchen	alarm
Japan	complain	undone
Japanese	absent	cousin
parasol	curtain	Muffet
furrow	possible	money
burrow	linen	compare
sensible	graceful	quarrel
eleven	delay	scarlet
disease	certain	almond
animal	successful	prepare
blanket	market	uncover
frolic	discover	honey
dangerous	Monday	honeycomb
instead	depart	shovel
nobody	August	garden

Review of phonograms. The words are new.

advance	troublesome	lullaby
harness	comfortable	repair
company	among	awkward
parents	monkey	partridge
Santa Clause	reward	thousands

---

ph = f	pheasant	cipher
Philip	photograph	camphor
Philippine	phonics	nephew
Ralph	Joseph	elephant
telephone	orphan	alphabet
telegraph	sulphur	geography

---

gh = f	rough	enough
cough	roughest	laugh
coughing	tough	laughing
trough	toughen	laughter

---

mn = m	autumn	solemn
hymn	column	condemn

ch = k	chorus	schooner
ache	school	anchor
echo	scholar	orchestra
Christmas	scheme	stomach

---

ch = sh	chute	Champlain
Chicago	Charlotte	ruching

---

sc = s	scene	scissors
scent	scenery	scythe

---

i = y	brilliant	Spaniard
onion	opinion	Daniel
union	companion	warrior
million	Italian	familiar

---

i = long e	machine	**qu = k**
trio	ravine	conquer
marine	police	mosquito
magazine	valise	

di – j	**silent h**	Rhine
soldier	John	exhaust
	heir	
ti = ch	hour	**et = long a**
question	honor	bouquet
suggestion	honest	croquet
digestion	ghost	crochet

---

	excursion	invitation
ce, ci, si, ti = sh	permission	vacation
	action	notion
	collection	motion
	correction	promotion
ocean	objection	mention
musician	station	attention
physician	nation	intention
precious	combination	position
delicious	relation	condition
special	recitation	addition

important	diamonds	druggist
snowflakes	postage	valuable
snowbirds	gentlemen	yesterday
forbid	holiday	perfect
forsake	subtract	remain
overload	twilight	direction
postpone	patient	parade
buttercups	mistletoe	electric
powerless	medicine	probably
president	fireman	farther
fastest	different	darling
today	post-office	forest
mistake	beneath	piano
oatmeal	underneath	pavement
excitement	messenger	costliest
snarl	janitor	tomorrow
railroad	unfold	anchor
lonesome	hundred	multiplication

Review of phonograms. The words are new.

SUGGESTIONS TO TEACHERS

Do not put this book into the hands of your pupils until you have carefully studied these suggestions.

The following plan approximates the progress of the average primary class. Do not attempt to follow it exactly. Keep in mind the fact that the ability of pupils differs greatly, and that whether a class falls behind the suggested plan of work or advances more rapidly, the one important thing is to teach each step thoroughly.

The amount of time given daily to the work in phonics must be decided by the teacher. Classroom conditions make it possible for some to give twenty minutes a day while others can give but ten. Two exercises a day of ten minutes each is perhaps the ideal arrangement. The exercise should never be continued until pupils weary of it. At the first indication of lagging or weariness it is time to stop.

The teaching of phonics includes

I Ear training,
II Tongue training,
III Eye training,
IV Word building.

Ear training may begin on the first day the child enters school. Say to the pupils, "We shall play a little game. You may do what I tell you, but do not speak a word." Then say to one, "Bring me a b-o-x," speaking the last word very slowly (phonetically); to others, "Show me something r-e-d," "Tap on your d-e-s-k," "Touch something made of t-i-n," " Cl-a-p your h-ands," "R-u-n to the d-oo-r," "H-o-p to the w-i-n-d-ow," etc. Sufficient interest will soon be aroused to permit the teacher to leave off the play and say words phonetically, one after another, asking pupils to tell what each word is. In a few days they will be able to recognize almost any word that may be sounded. Occasionally tell a little story, saying a word phonetically here and there, and allowing pupils to pronounce the word. This form of training may be profitably continued throughout the first half-year.

Tongue training should begin about the third or fourth day. Sound a word and have a pupil tell what sound he hears first, what sound he hears last. Be very careful that he gives the sound correctly. There is a natural inclination to voice a breath, or voiceless sound, such as *h*. Holding an object before a pupil, have him say the name slowly (phonetically), as *h-u-t, c-a-p, v-a-s-e, p-e-n, b-oo-k, f-a-n,* etc. A picture may be placed before the class, and a pupil may be asked to say phonetically the name of each thing he sees in the picture. After a few days' practice offer a sound (it may be a simple phonogram, as *l*, or a compound phonogram, as *sl*); have the pupils see how many different words they can think of

beginning with that sound. This training should be continued for several months. Ear training and tongue training should be practiced for eight or ten days before taking up eye training.

Eye training begins with the book, — teaching the pupil to associate the sound with the symbol. Ask the pupil to name the pictures on page 5; he says, *man, moon*. Ask him what sound he hears first (the ear and the tongue training have prepared the way for prompt recognition), and he will reply, *m*. Now tell him that the letters at the top of the page are pictures of the first sound and that hereafter they will help him to tell words. The pupil next learns the sound of *a*, in the same way. Then he learns the sound of *n*. Now he says the sounds of the three letters *m-a-n*, and thereby discovers the word *man*. At first the pupil will say these sounds so far apart that he cannot hear a word, but keep him trying to say them more rapidly, as, *m—a—n*, *m—a—n. m-a-n, m-a-n*, until he does hear the word and tells it. Proceed in like manner with the lessons that follow.

The order in which the phonograms are presented is based upon the ease with which they are blended.

In the early lessons tell the pupil only the sound of the letter that is illustrated. It is confusing to many pupils to be told the name of the letter at the same time that they are told its sound. Some teachers prefer not to teach the names of the letters until the pupils have worked on the sounds three or four months. Whenever a teacher feels sure that a pupil knows the sound of a letter so thoroughly that it will not confuse him to be told its name also, then it is time to teach him the name of the letter. It is not necessary for pupils to know the letters in alphabetical order until later.

The number of pages taken in a given lesson must be governed by the ability of the class. Take only as many as the pupils can do well.

During the first eight weeks pupils should have each lesson in both script and print. Write the lesson on the blackboard and have them practice it from that before practicing from the print in the book. By so doing, they will learn both forms simultaneously. As the lessons grow longer, limited time and blackboard space will prevent the teacher from presenting in script the whole of each day's work; but whenever a new phonogram or phonic principle is introduced, several of the words representing it should first be explained, sounded, and pronounced from the blackboard. Experience will soon enable the teacher to judge how much script practice is necessary to prepare the pupils for the book lesson.

This phonic course contains over 3500 different words. Each of these words when presented contains but one new phonogram, and that phonogram is the one introduced at the beginning of the series in which the word occurs.

Never tell the pupil a word in his phonic lesson, since only one new sound is introduced at a time, and the new step offers no difficulty if each foregoing page has been thoroughly learned.

When it is necessary to indicate a certain sound in a word, call it by number — the second sound, the third sound, or whatever it may be.

Concert recitation is helpful to timid pupils, and it saves time; but it should be avoided until the teacher is sure that each pupil participating in it can give the sound of every consonant correctly. The greater part of the phonic work should be individual.

Encourage pupils to whisper the sounds to themselves when they are studying a phonic or a reading lesson. Without actually hearing the sounds they cannot get the blend and therefore cannot discover the word. It takes several months for pupils to be able to blend the sounds mentally. This whispering is not disorder. It is a necessary part of word-getting and, if checked too soon, the pupils' progress in word-getting may be greatly retarded. When the proper time for overcoming it has arrived, — toward the latter part of the first year, — pupils will naturally dispense with it because they will be able to get the word so quickly through the eye that they will not wait for the assistance of the ear. An occasional request from the teacher that the pupil shall study to himself without moving the lips, will overcome it without difficulty.

Reserve a small space on the blackboard for a permanent phonic chart. As pupils learn the sounds of the consonants, write them at the left in this space; and as each new compound phonogram is learned, write it at the right. This affords good material for reviews and word-building lessons conducted in the following way: The teacher points to a consonant, then to a compound phonogram, and pupils tell what word these would make if written together; or a pupil takes the pointer and indicates combinations that will make familiar words while either he or other pupils pronounce them.

After all of its phonograms have been presented, the script alphabet should be placed along the top of the blackboard, and under each letter should be given the corresponding letter printed on paper or pasteboard. If it is on pasteboard it may be pinned to the blackboard; if on paper, paste it with library paste — it can easily be washed off when necessary. This affords ready reference for the entire class, familiarizing them with both the script and the printed forms. Do not print on the blackboard. The printing never looks exactly as it does in the book. Reserve the blackboard for script.

No diacritical marks are to be used. Pupils are taught to determine the sound of the vowel by its position in the word and by its associate letters. When pupils learn to read by means of diacritical marks their reading for the first year or more must be largely confined to the reader from which they are taught. The method

presented in this book gives the pupil immediate mastery of a word taught and the words of its family, regardless of where he may find them. Diacritical marks should not be taught until pupils are sufficiently advanced to use the dictionary.

Pupils should be taxed with the fewest possible rules. In this course only those are used which are simplest and most necessary for word-recognition. Do not require pupils to memorize them; frequent application of the principles involved will insure a thorough knowledge of them.

The separation of the family name from the initial sound greatly assists the pupil in acquiring the "blend." It becomes less necessary and is therefore used less frequently as the work proceeds. Strive for the "blend" at all times. The pupil's power to discover new words depends upon his ability to blend the sounds of which they are composed.

Constantly require pupils to apply their knowledge of phonics to their reading lesson; that is, do not tell the pupil a word in his reading lesson which he is able to get for himself. The habit of "making the sounds tell the word" must be thoroughly fixed. Thus the pupil will daily become more self-helpful, and after a few months his general knowledge of phonics will enable him to recognize many words containing sounds beyond his phonic training.

When a word occurs in the reading lesson that does not conform to the rule, as, *have*, *give*, etc., and the pupil pronounces it incorrectly, ask him if he knows such a word; when he replies that he does not, tell him there is something wrong with his vowel. He will immediately correct it and will soon learn to expect "exceptions," and to try another sound of a letter if his first sounding does not give him a familiar word, or a word that "makes sense" in the context.

If a word unusually long yet containing only sounds previously taught occurs in the reading lesson and seems difficult for the pupil, assist him by writing it on the blackboard and underscoring each compound phonogram or family name; also teach him to put a finger over such a word, moving it off slowly so that he sees but one family name or one syllable at a time. This may be well demonstrated to the class by using a long narrow strip of pasteboard with which to cover the word on the blackboard and removing it in the way described above. With a little training, pupils will soon learn to do this and will find it very helpful.

When the teacher discovers a weakness in a phonic principle previously taught, she should promptly refer the pupil or the class to a lesson which demonstrates that principle. If it is a forgotten phonogram, the pupil should be given a quick review of the family of words in which that phonogram is the common element.

Make up sets of script phonic cards for seat work. Write four or five families in as many columns on each card. Write the initial consonant sound in red ink and the compound phonogram or family name in black. Again write the consonant sound in red on strips of pasteboard and on other strips write the family names in

black. Cut these strips up so that there is but one consonant or one family name on each card. Pupils use these small cards for building families of words to correspond with those on the large card. Keep the small cards and the corresponding large one in the same envelope. When desired, the pupils may use the large cards for study or for copying. Each large card should be numbered on the back to correspond with the number of the envelope in which it belongs. Write on the outside of the envelope the name of each family included in the envelope; then it will not be necessary to look into the envelope in order to know what work the envelope contains.

When pupils have had a few weeks' practice in writing, begin conducting phonic spelling lessons, in order to reinforce the power to recognize compound phonograms. Write a family name on the blackboard, as, *at*; write it several times, one under another, making a column; now pronounce this family of words, — *cat, bat, fat, hat, mat, rat, pat, sat*, requiring different pupils to go to the blackboard and prefix the sound which makes the word. Or write on the blackboard the compound phonogram which is to be the common element of the series, then have the pupils copy it on their paper. Now pronounce the words, having children write as the words are pronounced. The ability to recognize compound phonograms as wholes, without separating them into their elementary sounds, greatly shortens the process of word recognition. This also serves to impress phonic principles upon the minds of the pupils and teaches them to apply those principles to all spelling, thus making spelling a matter of reasoning. Pupils should be taught to look over a spelling lesson, when one has been assigned that is made up of words of different families, and to determine the "dangerous places" in the words. For instance, in a spelling lesson of ten words, seven of those words may be strictly phonetic; that is, they may be governed by phonic principles and be spelled as they sound. The pupil does not need to waste time on these. But in the remaining three he finds unphonetic elements, so he studies only those three "exceptions." It is a good plan, in teaching children how to do this, to write the spelling lesson on the blackboard, making in red chalk the letters on which pupils are likely to trip. Some teachers have aptly called the "red danger signals."

If the pupils are taking up this course in the fall after having had part of the work the previous year, they should take a rapid review of the pages up to the point where their new lessons begin.

When pupils enter the class from schools in which this phonic course has not been taught, the most satisfactory method of preparing them for work with the class is to take them rapidly over the work which the class has covered.

Whether pupils complete this course in one year, one and a half, or two years, when they have completed it their ability to read anything they can comprehend is assured. Each pupil should keep the course in his desk for ready reference, general reviews, and drills, as required, until the close of his third school year.

The words in this book are grouped according to their pronunciation in Webster's New International Dictionary.

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Instructional Audio for *Word Mastery*

By Donald L. Potter

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Mr. Potter has prepared audio instruction in MP3 format that will teach each sound and spelling pattern in *Word Mastery*. The audio can be accessed from his websites www.donpotter.net and www.wordmastery.org.

Notes from the Internet Publisher: Donald L. Potter

December 20, 2004

I first learned of Akin's *Word Mastery* in 1997 from Charles Walcutt's recommendation in his 1961 prophetic book of essays, *Tomorrow's Illiterates.* Walcutt writes:

> This little book of 124 pages is as good today as it was forty-seven years ago, before the locust of look-and-say swarmed in upon us. It contains a beautifully organized, graded approach, beginning with letters and working up to the most irregular phonograms. With each new step, it introduces pages of words illustrating the element being taught, and the fact that it has already had a steady sale over all these years proves the existence of a considerable underworld of sober citizens. It seems obvious that this little book was used in conjunction with reading materials and that children in the first three grades were, in 1913, reading fluently even while their grasp of the niceties of English phonics was being strengthened.

I was unable to obtain a copy through the Interlibrary Loan or searches on the Internet. Eventually, Miss Geraldine Rodgers sent me a mint copy from her personal library. She reviewed *Word Mastery* in her magnum opus: *The History of Beginning Reading: From Teaching by "Sounds" to Teaching by "Meaning*. By Geraldine E. Rodgers, B.S., M.A., Educational Researcher with 23 years experience teaching primary grades. www.authorhouse.com, 1995, 2001. Here are her instructive comments:

> Mrs. Kathryn Diehl of Cincinnati, Ohio, who has done so much work for so many years for a reform in reading instruction, and who wrote her own phonics materials which are reviewed in this appendix, sent me her copy of Florence Akin's 1913 *Word Mastery, A Course in Phonics for the First Three Grades*. That copy had obviously been published sometime after its second copyright date of 1941. It is a straight Code 10 Phonics, and so, presumably was the 1908 material, *First Book in Phonics,* probably written by the same "F. Akin" but published by M. & G. Atkinson, not Riverside Press. The 1913-1941 material, however, is a child's textbook listed under "Readers" in the 1928 United States Catalog, while the 1908 material was listed under "Reading" (guides) instead of "Readers," (children's textbooks) in the 1912 United States Catalog. Since the original *Word Mastery* was published by Riverside in 1913, the same year that they published the new Riverside reading series, it seems possible that *Word Mastery* was obtained from Florence Akin for use as a supplement to Riverside's new 1913 series. Akin by that time already had a presumably successful 1908 phonics book and so would have been possible candidate for consideration (1395).
>
> Akin's "Suggestions to Teachers," pages. 112 to 117, followed by "List of Phonograms Studied" is an excellent guide to teaching Code 10 phonics. While some of her "Phonograms" are actually word parts instead of isolated phonemes, her guide suggests teaching them solely by the "sounds" and not by "meaning," so the material does rate Code 10. She organized this material in the early twentieth century, when supplementary phonics became the norm in American first grades, and she apparently had it on the market by 1908. Yet she obviously still expected the material to be solely "supplementary," as she referred to two ten-minute daily drills in phonics, to be done apart from the "reading" lessons. That Akin's excellent supplementary phonics materials was still being published by Houghton Mifflin as late as 1941, and very probably later, is very surprising, considering the Dick and Jane Readers. The Dick and Jane so-called "intrinsic" phonics of 1930 was intended to do away with the supplementary phonics drills, as Akin's, which had been around since shortly after 1900. However, apart from its listing in the United States Catalog of 1912 and 1928, I never saw any reference to Florence Akin's material until Mrs. Diehl sent the book to me from her collection of reading materials. It does not seem probable that the Akin's materials had any wide use after 1928, at which time it was listed in the United States Catalog as in print. Akin's 1913 material is STRAIGHT CODE 10 PHONICS. (1396)

The book that Miss Rodgers sent me (Donald Potter) is the same one Mrs. Diehl sent to her. We all owe Mrs. Diehl a debt of gratitude for preserving this invaluable phonics method.

The book must have been in print as late as 1961 for Walcutt to have recommended it in his book of essays published that year. In fact I have been told that it was still available in the early 1990's.

Let me explain what Miss Rodgers means by STRAIGHT CODE 10 PHONICS. In her *History of Reading*, she developed a system for classifying reading programs according to the percentage of phonics compared to the percentage of sight-words taught as meaningful configurational wholes accompanied by contextual guessing. According to Miss Rodgers, there are **only two ways** (or mixtures of those two ways) to teach beginning reading: from the "sounds" or from the "meanings." These two methods develop two distinctive and contrary types of readers: those who read accurately from the "sounds," and those who read (guess) inaccurately from the "meaning." On opposite ends of the spectrum: Code 1 programs are entirely "meaning" based, whereas Code 10 programs are entirely "sound" based. Codes in between are mixtures of the two. CODE 10 PHONICS programs are considered the purest and best. More information on theoretical aspects of reading can be found in Miss Rodgers' articles published on my website, www.donpotter.net.

I consider my publication of Akin's *Word Master* of more than historic interest. The labor of typing and editing this book was motivated by the firm belief that all children can learn to read well if they are taught by methods and materials like those in this book. The book has been continuously available as a free pdf file on my website since December 2004. The July 1, 2014 publication with CreateSpace is a further effort to help more students learn to read better. I wish every beginning reading student and every struggling reader in America had a copy of Akin's *Word Mastery*. The book includes everything necessary to teach anyone to read well with phonics.

It is my earnest hope that curriculum developers will use Akin's phonics system to guide them in the development of the reading methods American children will be using in the future.

I received a letter concerning *Word Mastery* from Marcia K. Henry (former President of the *Orton Dyslexia Society*) on February 2, 2007. She comments, "Re: Florence Akin's 1913 *Word Mastery*, I first started tutoring in Rochester, MN in 1959…almost 50 years ago! The director of the Reading Center was Paula Rome, whose uncle Paul Dozier was a neurologist with Dr. Samuel Orton. Paula gave me a copy of *Word Mastery* and said that was the only resource I would need to begin tutoring. I still have two extremely well-used copies!!"

There is an interesting reference to Akin's *Word Mastery* in Anna Gillingham's and Bessie Whitmore Stillman's *Remedial Reading Training for Children with Specific Disability in Reading, Spelling, and Penmanship* (1946), "*Word Mastery*, by Florence Akin. This book is part of the equipment with which we provide each teacher-in-training. While not essential it is a useful aid." (p. 4).

For a modern evaluation of Florence Akin's *Word Mastery*, see *Teaching Phonics to 21st-Century Children Using Early 20th-Century Techniques* by Dr. Leslie Kumer. This was her thesis for the Degree of Doctor of Education, Nova Southeastern University, 2007.

I choose `Century School Book Monotype` for the first half of the book in order to be able to keep all the letters in the words in the columns in perfect alignment. For the second half of the book, I choose Times New Roman.

Last update: 2/22/2019.

WORD MASTERY

A Course in Phonics for the First Three Grades

Prepared by

FLORENCE AKIN

Formerly a Teacher in Primary Grades, Portland, Oregon

1. It offers a system of effective and economical practice based on the latest and best theory of phonic analysis and word building.

2. It will give excellent results even in the hands of the teacher who lacks training in phonics.

3. It saves the teacher the labor and the time otherwise needed to plan a phonic course to be taught by means of blackboard and card devices.

4. It saves expense of charts and cards ordinarily required to supplement the reading lessons.

5. It gives the children greater independence in their study because they have the books in their own hands. It provides opportunity to the pupils to make up their individual deficiencies, without holding back the rest of the class.

6. It does away with the mechanical reading lesson – the reading of word repetitions without literary interest for the sake of phonic drill. The pupil becomes quick at word recognition, and the reading lesson can be devoted entirely to reading the best literature.

7. It is thorough and simple. Each lesson teaches one new phonic element and only one. There are thus no difficulties on the way, and the pupil steadily gains confidence in himself.

HOUGHTON MIFFLIN COMPANY

BOSTON NEW YORK CHICAGO

This page is an advertisement published in 1919 in the *Teachers' Manual of Silent and Oral Reading* by Emma Miller Bolenius, published by Houghton and Mifflin. The *Teacher's Manual* accompanied *The Boys' and Girls' Readers*.

Word Mastery

By Henry B. Dewey, Tacoma, Wash.

THIS little book, published by the Houghton Mifflin Company, is included in the Oregon state list as a book adapted for teachers' use, and is also on the list of books adopted by the city of Portland as a basal text in spelling for the lower grades. It can be truthfully called the "multum in parvo" method. In the first place it is an ideal system of teaching phonics, inexpensive, attractive, and economical of time and money. In the second place it is the best speller for the primary grades, in which capacity it is successfully used in a number of places.

The use of this text makes unnecessary the use of mechanical, uninteresting readers that destroy, at the outset, a child's innate love of good literature. When the pupil reads, it is either to get or to convey thought. The reading lesson then should be interesting and of genuine literary quality. The phonic lesson should be an exercise apart from the actual reading lesson—it is for the purpose of giving the child mastery over phonograms, so that when he reads his mind may be free for thought-getting. If the reader used is one of merit, it cannot be made up of the very short two, three, or four-letter words containing only the long and short vowels; even its early pages contain many words, which are not adapted for phonic analysis. The phonic course attempting to follow such a reader can not lead from the simple to the more difficult sounds, but compels pupils to struggle with difficult phonograms early in work, thus retarding their phonic progress by attacking phonics in an unnatural order. On the other hand, if the reader is made to fit the words of a systematic phonic course, the reading lessons are stilted and uninteresting. "Word Mastery" does not begin with the beginning words of any reader; but it does begin with the most simple phonograms, and covers a large percentage of the words of all primary readers, and gives the pupil greater power to discover new words than he could possibly gain by taking the phonics incidentally involved in the words of any primary reader.

"Word Mastery" saves the time and strength of teachers. Each lesson is right there, completely worked out; and the lessons are presented in a natural order—that is, in the order of their difficulty. It provides for constant review and use of phonics previously learned, thus securing mastery. With some phonic courses the pupil must learn the sound of every consonant before he learns the use of any one; that is, he does no word-building until the sounds of all the letters have been taught. With "Word Mastery" the pupil learns the use of every sound as fast as he gets it. He uses it in building every word in his vocabulary that it is possible to make with that sound and the sounds previously learned. He is making constant use of his entire stock of phonograms. His power to discover new words grows at a wonderful rate. Moreover, the work bears the same relation to spelling as to reading, and the benefit to the pupil in both reading and spelling cannot be overestimated.

Many experienced teachers have found that they secure the best results by having one or two five-minute periods a day, apart from the reading lesson, devoted to phonics.

While pupils are acquiring a vocabulary of "sight words" in the early pages of their primer, they will be gaining a mastery of the simplest and most fundamental phonic elements by the study of "Word Mastery." They will soon be able to use this knowledge of phonics in the recognition of new words in the reading lesson, and in a few months' time they will be able to make out most of the new words. Their daily increasing knowledge of phonics will make them less and less dependent on the teacher in their reading. It has been found that the use of this system of teaching phonics will give pupils of average ability ready command of a reading vocabulary of from 3000 to 4000 words in the first three grades, and enable them to read at sight any selection which is written within their comprehension.

In addition to the above-mentioned uses of "Word Mastery," it should be added that this book is of very great value in teaching foreigners to read, because it furnishes the quickest and surest means of learning the sounds used in pronouncing words.

Very full and detailed "Suggestions to teachers" in the back of the book give all necessary directions for the use of the book. Even in the hands of the teacher who lacks training in phonics, it will give excellent results.

Accessed June 16, 2010.
Oregon Teachers' Monthly, volume 19, September 1914, pages 194 – 195

HELPFUL SUGGESTIONS ABOUT TEXTBOOKS

AKIN'S WORD MASTERY.

By Henry B. Dewey, Tacoma, Wash.

If YOU are a primary teacher and have never taught a class to read by the use of Word Mastery you should give it a trial. You will get better results with less labor than ever before. Once tried you will never take a class through those first hard weeks of phonic training without it.

Word Mastery, by Miss Florence Akin, is a pupil's book and in order to get the best results it must be in the hands of each pupil. Where the pupil must depend upon the teacher to write the lessons on the blackboard, he gets only half or less than half of the training. He does not see the sounds in print in a book as he must in his reading, where he is expected to apply it; moreover if he is absent he misses the lessons taught in his absence, they are erased and he has no way of getting them; one link in the chain is missing. With the book in his own hands, the opportunity of coaching on any weak place is always at hand.

Let us consider the advantages in the use of Word Mastery in conjunction with any bright, interesting primary reader over the use of a method reader, that is, a reader in which the reading lesson is made to correspond with the phonic lesson. Turn to any page you choose in any method reader, a page in which the sentences are made up of such words as will illustrate the use of certain phonograms; now put yourself in the child's place. Would you like that for your reading lesson? It is not interesting, of course, but do not blame the author of the method reader, it is probably just as interesting as could possibly be made out of the sounds which it is intended to teach. Have you ever tried to write a bright little lesson using only certain phonograms? If not, try it. You will certainly find that you have quite a stilted, dull page. You cannot expect a child to be actually interested in it; on the contrary, it is disappointing because, in his own language, "There is no story."

Now take any primary reader which makes no claim to teaching phonics but one which may justly claim bright and interesting reading; if you were a child would you not prefer those bright little bits of verse or of story—something perhaps full of action? It was written for the purpose of telling something, giving the child a thought, while he is learning to read and not merely for the purpose of teaching certain words, which contain certain phonograms. There are such bright beautiful little readers offered by the publishing houses of the present day as were never dreamed of twenty years ago. Why not give them to the child while he is learning to read instead of compelling him to read from a book of sentences of which are merely a required combination of words? Of course it is true these words and phonograms have to be taught in order that the child may learn to read but Word Mastery would teach them as the mechanics of reading, mechanics which are kept in the background, an exercise apart from the actual reading lesson. Much enthusiasm and interest will be shown by a class running down a clear,

cleanly printed column of words all containing the same sound as in Word Mastery, whereas it would be difficult to arouse any special enthusiasm over the same words mixed up in a few uninteresting sentences. The pupil will get ten to twenty words containing the phonogram special to the lesson in Word Mastery, while the same phonogram could possibly be made use of in only four to eight words in the sentences of a reading lesson. When the pupil has mastered a long column of these words in Word Mastery he promptly gets the idea of applying them to all reading, not to that particular little reading lesson which they are made to fit—an idea which does cling to him for a time with the use of a method reader.

Give a child a method reader from which to work and in six weeks' time he will have developed phonetically more words in the lines of that reader than he would have developed in the same length of time in the lines of a reader which does not teach its phonic and reading lesson together. That is to say, he will have read more phonetically, and will have read less by the word method, than had he pursued Word Mastery in conjunction with a reader having no phonic method—but wait, at the end of four months' training the pupil who has pursued Word Mastery will have had as much phonic training and will have acquired as much independence in reading (all reading, not merely that which covers his stock of phonograms) as the pupil of the method reader will have in twice that length of time.

You ask "Why this wonderful growth in power after the first six weeks?" Because Word Mastery pursues phonics in a perfectly natural order; it begins right. It takes first the most simple sounds, those which may be prolonged, because every beginner in phonics prolongs, hangs on while he tries to get the next sound. Word Mastery does not begin with c-a-t or any similar word containing an explosive sound. The pupil would say **c**, which is explosive; it is gone from his hearing before he can get **a**. But Word Mastery does begin with m-a-n. The pupil says **m** and he hangs on, of course he does, and when he can say **a** he still hears that **m**, consequently he gets the idea and the blend right at the beginning. Word Mastery continues with these sounds, which may be prolonged **r**, **s**, **c**, etc. When finally it does take up its first explosive sound, it is first mastered at the end of the word as **t** in s-a-t and afterword as the initial sound.

Every step of Word Mastery is made so simple and every new sound is so thoroughly mastered by combining it with sounds previously learned that in a few months' time a pupil will have built such a firm foundation in phonics as it would be impossible to build in the same length of time by pursuing phonics in any other way.

But again the teacher asks, "How does one apply it to the reading lesson when it is not made to fit?" Simply this, Word Mastery first covers all words of two and three letters which have the short sounds of the vowels. As the pupil reads he is taught the words of his reading lesson merely as whole or sight words, excepting those words in the reading lesson that contain not over two or three letters and that have the short sound of the vowel. Any teacher will see these words at a glance. At the reading lesson the pupil is then required to get these words for himself, developing them phonetically. Next come

the words of four letters, words having final e, giving the first vowel in the words the long sound. As soon as the pupil has had some training with these words having final e he is required to get them without assistance when they appear in the reader. Next are the words having final **s**, as **caps**, **pets**, etc. Then the words of four letters, the last two of which have the same sound—**lock**, **mill**, **muff**, and so on, one step at a time to the very end of the book. The pupil constantly grows in phonic power and constantly mastering from his reader those words, which appear within his phonic training.

Put a Word Mastery into the hands of each of your pupils now, and in four months' time you will say that you will never teach a primary class without it.

Accessed June 16, 2010.
Oregon Teachers' Monthly. Volume 19, September 1914, pages 495 – 496.

Note: 1907 - Dewey had an A. B. from the University of Michigan. He was the Pacific Coast Agent, Houghton Mifflin Co., 406 N. D St., Tacoma. From the NEA Yearbook and List of Active Members for the Year Beginning December 31, 1914, and ending December 31, 1915. p. 311. From a digitized copy from the University of California.

The above reference indicates his connection with the publisher of *Word Mastery* as Agent.

Dewey may have died around April 1932 because there is an article entitled, "Henry B. Dewey Departed" by Frank. B. Nalder.

He was Secretary of Public Instruction, Olympia, Washington in 1911. See *Humane Education* 1911.